MATTHEW K. RIBAR

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Washington University in St. Louis July 2025 - present
Postdoctoral fellow at the Weidenbaum Center on the Economy, Government, and Public Policy

EDUCATION

Stanford University 2025
Ph.D. in Political Science

- Fields: Comparative Politics, Political Methodology, and International Relations.
- Committee: Jeremy Weinstein (co-chair), David Laitin (co-chair), Avidit Acharya, and James Fearon.
- Dissertation project: Land, Power, and Property Rights: The Political Economy of Land Titling in West Africa.

Stanford University 2022
M.A. in Political Science

College of William & Mary | University of St Andrews 2017
B.A. (International Honors) International Relations, minor in Economics

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

2026 Matthew K. Ribar. Intra-respondent reliability and enumerator quality in field conjoint experiments. *Political Science Research & Methods* (conditionally accepted).

2026 Alma Bezares Calderón, Simon Mercer, Ifeoluwa M. Olawole, and Matthew K. Ribar. Belonging, violence, and natural resource governance: experimental evidence from Mali and Niger. *Journal of Peace Research* (forthcoming).

2025 Matthew K. Ribar. Land, Power, and Property Rights: The Political Economy of Land Titling in sub-Saharan Africa. *American Political Science Review* 120 (2): 399-418 [replication file].

- African Politics Conference Group's 2025 'Best Graduate Student Paper' award.

2025 Rebecca Janssen and Matthew K. Ribar. Expertise, accuracy, and reputation inflation in the wine market: Evidence from Vivino ratings. *Journal of Wine Economics* 20(4): 348-370.

2025 Matthew K. Ribar. Feeding conflict? New data on the impact of humanitarian food aid on civil conflict. *Journal of Global Security Studies* 10(2) [replication files].

2017 Matthew K. Ribar. Keeping Up with the Times: How the Discipline of International Relations Responds to Benchmark Events. *International Studies Perspectives*, 18(3): 304-322.

- Published as a SAGE Research Methods Case Study [link].

WORKING PAPERS

1. Getting to Youths: Development Programming, Conflict Resolution, and Political Violence in Niger (with Kathryn M. Lance, Ryan Sheely, and Ifeoluwa M. Olawole) [link to working paper].

   - Invited to revise and resubmit at the *American Journal of Political Science*.

2. Trust and Betrayal in Wartime: How Ukrainians Evaluate Foreign Support During the Russian Invasion (with Margit Tavits and Carly Wayne). **Under review**. Available upon request.
3. When War Hits Home: Conflict Exposure and Domestic Violence in Ukraine (with Margit Tavits and Carly Wayne). **Under review**. Available upon request.
4. Land, power, and property rights: Conjoint evidence from Sénégal and Côte d'Ivoire. Structural Transformation and Economic Growth' (STEG) working paper no. 72 [link to working paper]
5. Radio Messaging and Community Acceptance of Ex-Combatants: experimental evidence from the eastern Democratic Republic of the Congo (with Ifeoluwa M. Olawole) [link to working paper].
6. Indirect Rule and the Endurance of Traditional Governance in Africa, prepared for *The Oxford Handbook on Traditional Law & Governance in Africa* (with Joan Ricart-Huguet) [link to draft].

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

7. Attention land predators! Power and Property in Rural West Africa (book manuscript in progress).
8. Who settles your land palavas? Ambient legitimacy and institutional change in rural Liberia [link to pre-analysis plan].
9. Social cohesion and exposure to violent conflict: Evidence from a panel survey in Ukraine (with Margit Tavits, and Carly Wayne).
10. Trust Issues: How Citizens Evaluate State Interventions During Armed Conflict (with Ifeoluwa M. Olawole) [link to pre-analysis plan].
11. Customary institutions and social cohesion after war (with Margit Tavits) [link to pre-analysis plan].
12. Gendered Backlash to Land Tenure Reform in Rural Liberia [link to pre-analysis plan]
13. Land Registration in Côte d'Ivoire: Consolidation of a national, land-owning elite (with Catherine Boone).
14. Inventing custom? Evidence from court records in colonial Senegal (with Joan Ricart-Huguet and Lindsey Pruett).
15. Escaping the Lean Season Trap: Emergency Food Assistance and Household Resilience in the Sahel (with Horace Gninafon, Jordan Kyle, and Philip Roessler) [link to pre-analysis plan].

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

16. The Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH) Project in Cabo Verde: Interim Evaluation Report. 2020. Report submitted to the Millennium Challenge Corporation. Washington, DC: Mathematica Policy Research (with Clair Null, Edith Felix, Audrey Moore, Abbie Turiansky, Jane Fortson, Evan Fantozzi, Dara Bernstein, Emma Pottinger, and Loay Hidmi) [link to paper].
17. Evaluation Design Report for the Liberia Energy Project: Activities 1 and 2. 2018. Report submitted to the Millennium Challenge Corporation. Washington, DC: Mathematica Policy Research (with Candace Miller, Kristine Bos, Ali Protik, Randall Blair, and Paolo Abarcar) [link to paper].
18. Evaluation of the Irrigation and Water Resource Management Project in Senegal: Interim Report. 2018. Report submitted to the Millennium Challenge Corporation. Washington, DC: Mathematica Policy Research (with Thomas Coen, Sarah Hughes, William Valetta, and Kristen Velyvis) [link to paper].
19. Implementing the Arms Trade Treaty and the UNPoA: A Guide to Coordinating an Effective Arms Control System. 2018. Sydney: Centre for Armed Violence Reduction (with Laura Spano, Philip Alpers, and Erly Munoz) [link to paper].
20. Where the World Comes Up Short: Gaps in Civil Society Efforts to Combat the Proliferation of Small Arms. 2016. Melbourne: Pacific Small Arms Action Group.

GRANTS

2025 Weidenbaum Center on the Economy, Government, and Public Policy Small Grant (with Margit Tavits) ($22,727)

2025 Reducing Conflict and Improving Performance in the Economy (UK Foreign, Commonwealth, & Development Office) Small Research Grant (£26,350).

2023 SurveyCTO Primary Data Collection Research Grant ($1,000).

2023 Stanford King Center for International Development Advanced Grant ($10,000).

2023 Institute for Humane Studies Expense Support ($ 5,000).

2023 Peace Science Society Graduate Student Travel Grant ($400).

2023 Institute for Humane Studies Expense Support ($ 750).

2023 Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR) Schultz Research Fellowship ($ 4,000).

2022 Structural Transformation and Economic Growth (UK Foreign, Commonwealth, & Development Office) Ph.D. Research Grant (£24,535).

2022 Stanford King Center for International Development Advanced Grant ($ 10,000).

2021 Stanford King Center for International Development Exploratory Grant ($ 5,000).

2021 National Science Foundation Graduate Student Research Fellowship.

2014 International Studies Association Student Travel Grant.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2023 Junior Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies

2023 Junior Scholar, Carnegie International Policy Scholar Consortium and Network

2021–25 Stanford Center for African Studies Graduate Fellow

2021–25 Immigration Policy Lab Graduate Fellow

2021 Stanford Impact Labs / Immigration Policy Lab Summer Fellow

2019–25 Stanford University Graduate Fellowship

2013 Phi Beta Kappa

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 American Political Science Association.

2025 American Political Science Association, Midwest Political Science Association, World Bank Land and Poverty Conference, Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science, University College London Conflict & Change Workshop (**declined**).

2024 Midwest Political Science Association, Governance and Local Development Institute Annual Conference, World Bank Land and Poverty Conference, American Political Science Association, Society for Political Methodology (**declined**), African Politics Conference Group Online Colloquium.

2023 Peace Science Society; American Political Science Association; Midwest Political Science Association.

2022 Midwest Political Science Association; Working Group in African Political Economy Annual Conference.

2020 Midwest Political Science Association; Stanford Graduate Student Comparative Workshop.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Comparative Political Behavior, with Margit Tavits (2026)
- Introduction to International Relations, with Jim Fearon (2019)
- The Science of Politics, with Jeremy Weinstein and Jonathan Rodden (2021)
- Data Science for Politics, with Alain Schläpfer (2021)

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mathematica Policy Research — Washington, DC
Program Associate — June 2017 - August 2019

Pacific Small Arms Action Group/Center for Armed Violence Reduction — Melbourne, Australia
Consultant — June 2017 - September 2017
Policy and Outreach Associate — May 2016 - September 2016

Teaching, Research, and International Policy Project — Williamsburg, USA
Research Assistant — November 2013 - June 2017

DEPARTMENTAL AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Reviewer: American Political Science Review, American Journal of Political Science
- APSA mentorship program (2022-2025)
- Stanford 'Pathways to Ph.D.' mentor program (2022-2024)
- Departmental cohort representative (2020)